LEARN · GRAMMAR

A2

First Conditional



Use the first conditional for real, likely situations in the future — **if this happens, that will be the result**.

RULE #1: NEVER "WILL" IN THE IF-CLAUSE

IF + present simple
if it rains…

→

WILL + base verb
…we'll cancel the trip.

can / might / should can also replace "will" in the result

✗ **If you will study, you'll pass.**

✓ **If you study, you'll pass.**

"unless" already means "if not" — don't double it

✗ Unless you don't hurry… → ✓ Unless you hurry…

1 Form

If + present simple, + will + base verb. The if-clause NEVER uses 'will' — that's the #1 rule to remember. The main clause can also use can, might, or should instead of 'will'.

- **If** it rains, we**'ll cancel** the trip.
- If it rains, we **might stay** home.
- If you're tired, you **should rest**.

2 Other words instead of 'if'

unless = if … not
Unless you hurry, you'll be late. = If you don't hurry, you'll be late.

as long as / provided that = only if
You can go out **as long as** you finish your homework.

3 Use

A real possibility with a likely result, warnings, and promises and offers.

- If she **studies** hard, she**'ll pass** the exam.
- If you don't leave now, you**'ll miss** the train.
- If you help me move, I**'ll buy** you dinner.

4 Common mistakes

✗ If you will study, you'll pass.	✓ **If you study, you'll pass.**	never 'will' in the if-clause
✗ Unless you don't hurry…	✓ **Unless you hurry…**	'unless' already means 'if not'
✗ If it rains, we cancel the trip.	✓ **If it rains, we'll cancel the trip.**	main clause needs 'will'
✗ If he trains harder, he will wins.	✓ **If he trains harder, he will win.**	base verb after 'will'

APPLY · PRACTICE

A2

First Conditional Practice

A Choose the correct word

1. If it ___ tomorrow, we'll cancel the trip. **(rains / will rain / rained)**
2. If we take the motorway, we ___ there faster. **(get / will get / would get)**
3. If she ___ hard, she'll win the scholarship. **(study / studies / studied)**
4. Unless she ___ soon, we'll start without her. **(arrive / arrives / arrived)**
5. She ___ upset if you forget her birthday. **(will be / would be / is)**
6. If they don't hurry, they ___ the flight. **(will miss / miss / missed)**

B Complete with the verb in brackets

1. If she misses the bus, she ___ (be) late.
2. Unless the weather ___ (improve), the concert will be moved indoors.
3. If she ___ (finish) work early, she'll join us for dinner.
4. We won't finish on time if everyone ___ (not / help).
5. If the shop ___ (be) open, we'll buy some milk.
6. If the internet ___ (go) down, we'll lose all our work.

C Find and fix the mistake

1. If you will study hard, you'll pass the exam.
2. Unless you don't hurry, we'll miss the show.
3. You'll feel better if you will rest.
4. If we don't hurry, we miss the flight.
5. If it snows tomorrow, we will staying home.
6. If it rained tomorrow, we'll cancel the picnic.

D Write each warning two ways

1. you / wear a coat / be cold
   IF ... NOT _____ **UNLESS** _____
2. you / take an umbrella / get wet
   IF ... NOT _____ **UNLESS** _____
3. you / hurry up / miss the train
   IF ... NOT _____ **UNLESS** _____
4. you / finish your vegetables / get dessert
   IF ... NOT _____ **UNLESS** _____

E Speak

say it out loud with a partner

1. Make three first conditional sentences about what you will do this weekend.
2. Use first conditional to give a warning to a friend about a bad habit.
3. What will you do if you don't understand something in class?